Question ID f25a34aa

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear functions	

ID: f25a34aa

The area of a triangle is equal to x^2 square centimeters. The length of the base of the triangle is $2x + 22$ centimeters, and the height of the triangle is $x - 10$ centimeters. What is the value of x?

ID: f25a34aa Answer

Correct Answer:
110

Rationale

The correct answer is 110. The area of a triangle is equal to one half of the product of the length of the base of the triangle and the height of the triangle. It's given that the length of the base of the triangle is $2x + 22$ centimeters and the height of the triangle is $x - 10$ centimeters; therefore, its area is $\frac{1}{2}(2x + 22)(x - 10)$ square centimeters. It's also given that the area of the triangle is equal to x^2 square centimeters. Therefore, it follows that $\frac{1}{2}(2x + 22)(x - 10) = x^2$. This equation can be rewritten as $(x + 11)(x - 10) = x^2$, or $x^2 + x - 110 = x^2$. Subtracting x^2 from both sides of this equation yields $x - 110 = 0$. Adding 110 to both sides of this equation yields $x = 110$. Therefore, the value of x is 110.

Question Difficulty:
Hard